A pipeline built for a laptop had five gaps for a shared cluster

From our KittenTTS-indic fine-tune: 5 hours on one NVIDIA H200, 19,470 steps

Three gaps in how the job starts, resumes and counts

01 **No training entry point**

A batch job needs one command that runs end to end.

02 **No resume after a requeue**

Slurm can requeue a job. Without checkpoint resume, it restarts at step zero.

03 **An epoch counter that never advanced**

Anything keyed to epochs never fires.

Two gaps were in what goes into the run and what comes out of it

01

No export or LoRA merge

The run would end with an adapter and no model anyone could serve.

02

No tokenizer check between data shards and checkpoint

We swapped the tokenizer to Sarvam-1. A mismatch would feed the model the wrong token IDs.

The cluster added three demands a laptop never makes

01 **Ask for GPUs by GRES**

This Slurm setup wanted GPUs as generic resources, with no separate memory request.

02 **Compute nodes have no internet**

Stage models and tokenizers on shared storage first.

03 **Memory-mapping can fail**

Mapping the 3.5 GB safetensors file failed with ENOMEM. Keep a fallback loader.

What we would do first next time

> **Run a two-step job on the real cluster before the real run.**

Scheduler, network and storage gaps show up in minutes, before the GPU hours start.

What broke the first time you moved a job onto Slurm?

We take GPU and HPC workloads from problem statement to code your team runs.

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